

The Google Business Profile Checklist for Cafés & Restaurants

25 things to fix on your Google listing so customers walk in and order direct — not through UberEats.

UberEats, DoorDash and Menulog charge you 25–35% per order. On a \$50 dinner that's \$15 out the door before you've paid for ingredients, staff or rent.

Your Google Business Profile is the single biggest free tool you have to win those customers back — in the door or ordering direct. This checklist fixes the bits most operators get wrong. Takes about an hour. Print it, tick each box as you go.

1. Foundation

THE BASICS — GET THESE WRONG AND NOTHING ELSE MATTERS

☐ Claim and verify your listing

If Google doesn't trust you own the business, you can't edit anything. Search your business name on Google and look for "Own this business?"

☐ Business name matches your real signage

No keyword stuffing. "Joe's Pizza Best Pizza Bairnsdale" gets you suspended. Just your real venue name.

☐ Address is correct and consistent

It must match exactly what's on your website, your menu, your invoices, and any directory or delivery-app listings.

☐ Phone number is your direct line

Not a UberEats forwarding number, not a third-party reservation line. The number you answer when it rings on the bench.

☐ Website link points to your own site

Not your UberEats or DoorDash page. Your own domain, your own menu, your own booking page if you have one.

2. Categories & Attributes

TELL GOOGLE EXACTLY WHAT YOU ARE

- ☐ **Primary category set correctly**
"Cafe," "Italian restaurant," "Pizza restaurant," "Bakery," "Brunch restaurant," "Coffee shop" — pick the most specific one. "Steakhouse" beats "Restaurant" every time.
 - ☐ **Add 2–4 secondary categories**
Add things like "Coffee shop," "Takeout restaurant," "Catering service," "Wine bar," "Breakfast restaurant" if they apply. Don't pad with stuff that isn't true.
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- ☐ **Tick every relevant dining attribute**
Dine-in, takeaway, delivery, outdoor seating, accepts reservations, good for groups, kids menu, dog-friendly — customers filter searches by these.
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- ☐ **Set accessibility attributes honestly**
Step-free entrance, accessible parking, accessible restroom, gender-neutral toilet. Diners actively search for these.

3. Hours & Contact

NO SURPRISES FOR HUNGRY PEOPLE

- ☐ **Trading hours match the kitchen, not just the door**
If the kitchen closes 30 minutes before the venue, set the closing time to when last orders go in. Nothing tanks a review like a 9pm walk-in who's told "kitchen's closed."
 - ☐ **Public holidays and seasonal closures added**
Use the "Special hours" feature for Christmas, Easter, Anzac Day, off-season closures. "Open" when you're actually shut is the fastest way to a 1-star.
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- ☐ **Description fills the full 750 characters**
Plain English. Mention your cuisine, your town, what makes you different, whether you take walk-ins or need a booking.

4. Menu

PEOPLE SEARCH "[YOUR TOWN] MENU" CONSTANTLY — SHOW UP FOR IT

☐ **Menu uploaded directly to your GBP — and current**

In your GBP dashboard, add menu items by section (Mains, Sides, Drinks). Stale menus — old prices, missing dishes, removed specials — get you bad reviews. Update it whenever you re-price.

☐ **Menu link + price range (\$/\$\$/\$\$\$) point to your own site**

Not your UberEats menu — your own menu page (a clean PDF works if you don't have one yet). Set the price-range attribute honestly so diners filter you in, not out.

5. Photos

FOOD SELLS — THIS IS WHERE MOST OPERATORS LOSE THE WALK-IN

☐ **10+ hero food shots, well-lit, no filters**

Top sellers and signature dishes. Natural daylight near a window, plate styled, no harsh phone flash. Diners decide on the photo before they read a word of menu.

☐ **Interior shots showing ambiance and seating**

Empty room daytime shot, busy night shot (lights on, candles, people enjoying themselves at a distance — not faces). Show the vibe people are paying for.

☐ **Exterior + signage shot from the street, refreshed monthly**

Daylight, no cars blocking the door — so drivers and walk-ins recognise the place. Add a fresh photo (new special, seasonal dish) at least monthly; Google rewards active listings.

6. Direct Reservations & Online Ordering

WHERE THE 30% COMMISSION SAVINGS ACTUALLY HAPPEN

☐ **Reservation link goes to your own booking page**

In the GBP dashboard, set "Reservations" to your direct booking URL — not OpenTable, not a third-party reservation platform that takes a per-cover fee.

☐ **Order link goes to your own ordering page (not UberEats)**

If you do takeaway or delivery, set the "Order online" link to your own ordering page. Even a simple "Call to order" tel: link beats sending Google traffic to a 30%-commission middleman.

☐ **Messaging turned on (and someone's watching it)**

Lets diners text you from search to ask about bookings, dietary requirements, dogs. Big trust signal. Be ready to reply within an hour during trading.

Why this matters

Google now lets diners book, message and order from search results without ever clicking through to your site. If your order link points at UberEats, you've just paid 30% commission on a customer Google sent you for free. Send them to your own site or your own number every single time.

7. Reviews, Posts & Q&A

THE ONGOING WORK THAT KEEPS YOU AHEAD OF QUIETER COMPETITORS

☐ Reply to every review — good and bad

Within 48 hours. By name, personalised, never copy-paste. A polite, professional reply to a 2-star wins more new diners than the bad review costs.

☐ Set up a review request system

A small card on the table, a QR sticker on the EFTPOS machine, or a follow-up email after a booking — with your direct Google review link on it. Aim for one new review per week.

☐ Get your short Google review link

In your GBP dashboard, click "Ask for reviews" — copy that short link, save it, print it on the table cards.

☐ Post an update every 2–4 weeks

A new special, a seasonal menu, a function announcement, a great photo from last weekend. Counts as a fresh signal to Google and shows up directly in your listing.

☐ Pre-load the Q&A section

Add the questions diners actually ask — parking, BYO, kids welcome, dog-friendly, gluten-free, set-menu pricing — and answer them yourself. Saves you replying 50 times.

Done it all? Here's what's next.

If you've ticked every box, your Google Business Profile is now in better shape than 95% of cafés and restaurants in your town. Want a hand keeping more of those customers direct instead of handing 25–35% to UberEats? Get in touch — find me on Facebook or Instagram as Your Mate Agency, or my email and number are right below.

Your Mate Agency — helping regional businesses get found online.

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